Calming the Storm: Managing Big Emotions

Phillip Jaskot, PMHNP-BC

Hi, I'm Phillip Jaskot, a psychiatric nurse practitioner with Real Psychiatric Services. It's a privilege to be your guide for this next, crucial part of your toolkit.

In the first two parts of this course, you've built an incredible foundation—you've learned to understand your body's alarm system and to investigate the thoughts that can trigger it.

Now, we'll address the moments when an emotion feels so powerful that it hijacks everything. In my years as an ICU nurse, I worked in many high-pressure situations and learned that sometimes, before we can think our way through a problem, we first need to calm the crisis in the body. That's what this part of the course is all about.

My philosophy is that **you're the expert on your life.** My role is to offer you a set of proven tools and guide you as you learn to use them. The skills you're about to learn are designed to put you back in the driver's seat, especially when your emotions feel out of control.

Let's begin.

The Emotional Hurricane

When Thinking Isn't Enough

Sometimes emotions are too powerful for cognitive strategies. It's like trying to reason with a hurricane.

Physiological Responses

Your body's alarm system creates physical reactions that need direct intervention.

Immediate Relief

Before complex problem-solving, we need to calm the crisis in the body.

Introducing DBT Skills

Crisis Survival

Immediate, four-step TIPP skill to quickly de-escalate emotional crises.

Grounding

Simple five senses technique to pull yourself back to the present moment.

Emotional Surfing

Learning to ride emotional waves rather than fighting against them.

Crisis Survival: The TIPP Skill

Temperature Change

Splash cold water on your face or hold an ice pack to reset your nervous system.

Intense Exercise

Brief physical activity like jumping jacks or push-ups to burn excess adrenaline.

Paced Breathing

Slow your breathing to 5-6 breaths per minute, extending your exhale.

Progressive Muscle Relaxation

Tense and release muscle groups to reduce physical tension.

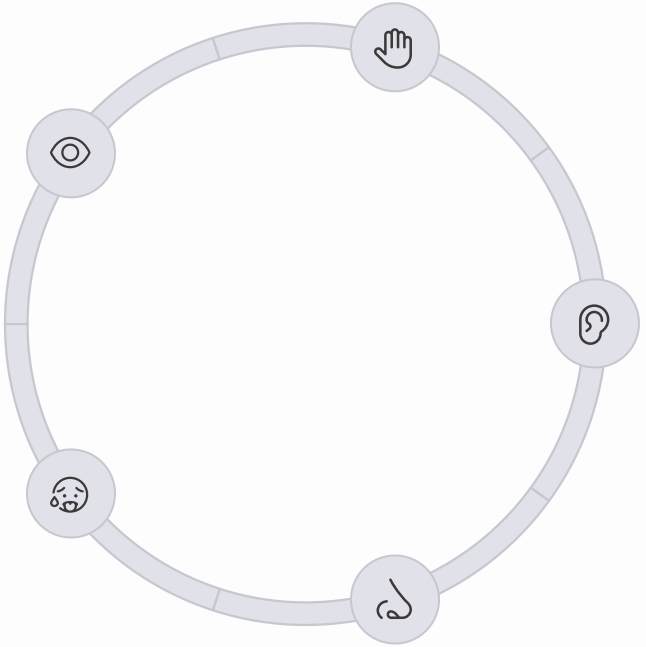
Grounding: The 5-4-3-2-1 Technique

5 Things You See

Notice details around you: colors, shapes, movements.

1 Thing You Taste

Notice the taste in your mouth.



4 Things You Feel

Focus on physical sensations: texture, temperature, pressure.

3 Things You Hear

Listen for sounds: distant, close, subtle.

2 Things You Smell

Identify scents in your environment.

Emotional Surfing

1. **Recognition**

   Name the emotion as it begins. This activates your prefrontal cortex.

2. **Acceptance**

   Allow the feeling without judgment. Resistance increases suffering.

3. **Observation**

   Watch the emotion's intensity rise and fall like a wave.

4. **Passage**

   Trust that all emotions eventually subside. Nothing lasts forever.

Putting Skills Into Practice

1. **Start Small**

   Practice these skills during minor stress before major emotional storms.

2. **Create Reminders**

   Keep skill cue cards in your wallet, phone background, or refrigerator.

3. **Track Your Progress**

   Note which skills work best for different emotions.

4. **Be Patient**

   These are skills that improve with practice. Celebrate small wins.

More about Phillip Jaskot

About Phillip Jaskot, PMHNP-BC

From your initial meeting with Phillip, you'll notice his steady confidence and genuine empathy. With over six years of experience as an ICU and Interventional Radiology nurse, Phillip is adept at navigating high-pressure situations—skills he now channels into calm, focused, and thoughtful mental health support. As a board-certified Psychiatric Mental Health Nurse Practitioner, he blends clinical rigor with a warm, approachable style, making it easy to open up and feel truly heard.

Phillip's approach is rooted in collaboration, empathy, and respect. He believes mental wellness flourishes when every facet of your world is considered: relationships, daily routines, stressors, and strengths. He creates a safe, supportive space where your questions are always welcome and every treatment decision is made together.

> *"You're the expert on your life. I'm here to listen, guide, and offer options—whether that's therapy techniques, lifestyle tweaks, or medication—so you feel empowered every step of the way."*

Patients describe Phillip as collaborative, transparent, and deeply respectful. He is committed to honest communication and guiding you through your mental health journey with confidence.

For more about Phillip's background, philosophy, and the full provider team, visit:
realpsychiatricservices.com/meet-your-providers